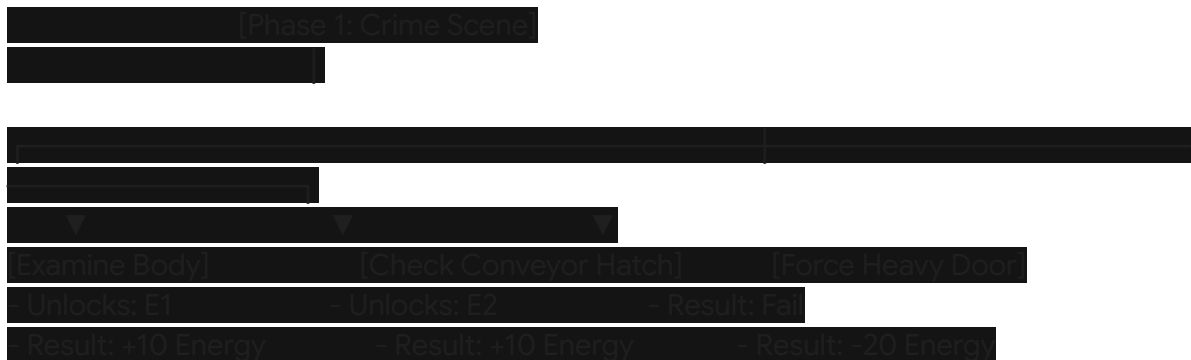


Game Systems Overview

- **Starting Energy:** 100 AP (Action Points).
- **Investigation Gate:** Requires at least **4 out of 6 clues** collected to initiate the final accusation.
- **Failure State:** If Energy drops to 0, the police captain pulls you from the case for reckless investigation.

Phase 1: The Sealed Cleanroom (Crime Scene)

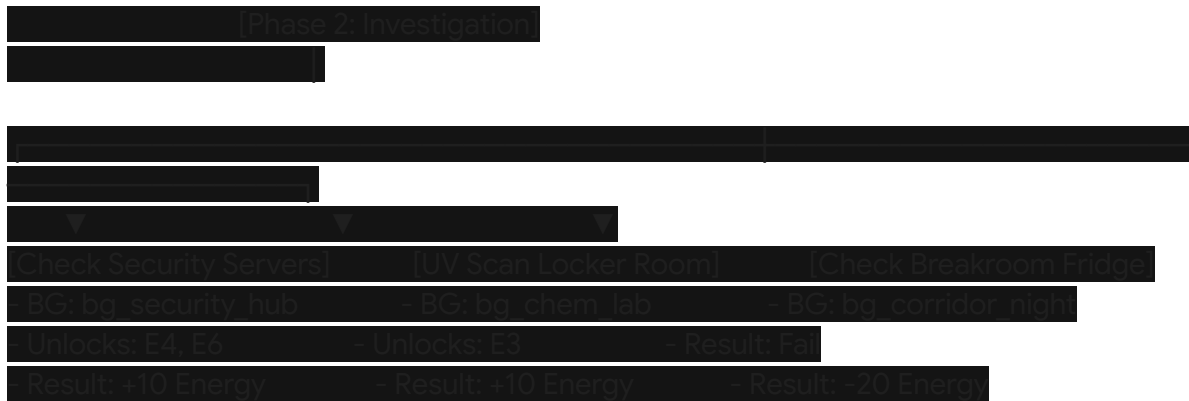
- **Background:** bg_cleanroom_int.png
- **Default Sprite:** thorne_deceased.png



- **Choice 1A: Examine Dr. Thorne's body.**
 - *Text:* You turn on your forensic light and examine how the blood has pooled across his back.
 - *Dialogue (Detective):* "The blood settled flat against his spine. He died lying flat on the floor, not sitting in this chair. Someone moved him here after he died."
 - *Reward:* Unlocks **E1 (Body Position Clue)** | **+10 Energy**
- **Choice 1B: Inspect the small conveyor pass-through hatch on the wall.**
 - *Text:* You inspect the motorized intake belt used for silicon wafers.
 - *Dialogue (Detective):* "There are fiber tears and faint scuffs in the rubber rollers. Someone pushed a heavy object through this opening."
 - *Reward:* Unlocks **E2 (Conveyor Belt Clue)** | **+10 Energy**
- **Choice 1C: Kick and rattle the locked glass airlock door.**
 - *Text:* You slam your shoulder into the reinforced pressure door. It doesn't budge.
 - *Dialogue (Detective):* "Ouch... Solid magnetic locks. Forcing it won't uncover anything."
 - *Penalty:* No clue found | **-20 Energy**

Phase 2: The Security Hub & Lab Bay

- **Background:** Transitions between bg_security_hub.png and bg_chem_lab.png



- **Choice 2A: Access the main security server console.**
 - *Background:* bg_security_hub.png
 - *Text:* You pull up the camera blackout timestamps and Bluetooth radio logs.
 - *Dialogue (Detective):* "The cameras dropped at 03:14 AM. Kevin Lin's smartwatch synced with this console right at that second. And right after, the cleanroom ran an automated 65°C heat purge."
 - *Reward:* Unlocks **E4 (Smartwatch Log) & E6 (Heat Sterilizer Log) | +10 Energy**
- **Choice 2B: Use a UV blacklight on the lab coats in the testing bay.**
 - *Background:* bg_chem_lab.png
 - *Sprite:* elena_defensive.png
 - *Dialogue (Elena):* "Are you implying I don't follow cleanroom hygiene, Detective?"
 - *Dialogue (Detective):* "Her coat cuff glows bright neon blue. That's Fluorinert coolant from Sector 7. She was inside after hours."
 - *Reward:* Unlocks **E3 (Blue Chemical Stain) | +10 Energy**
- **Choice 2C: Search the cafeteria fridge for leftovers.**
 - *Background:* bg_corridor_night.png
 - *Text:* You sift through expired lunchboxes and soda cans.
 - *Dialogue (Detective):* "Nothing here but old sandwiches. Total waste of time."
 - *Penalty:* No clue found | **-20 Energy**

Phase 3: The Interrogations & Penthouse Office

- **Background:** bg_executive_office.png → bg_interrogation_room.png

Investigation Action: Search the CEO's Suite

- **Background:** bg_executive_office.png
- **Choice 3A: Search Marcus Vance's desk and laptop.**
 - *Text:* You open the mahogany desk drawer and inspect the laptop terminal.
 - *Dialogue (Detective):* "Found an encrypted draft from Dr. Thorne: 'Pull the fake sensor data by 8:00 AM or the authorities get everything.' Vance had a direct motive to silence

him."

- *Reward: Unlocks E5 (Threatening Email) | +10 Energy*

Suspect Confrontations (Interrogation Room)

- **Background:** bg_interrogation_room.png

Interrogate Suspects

— Dr. Elena Cruz, Present E3 (Blue Stain) → Sprite switches to: elena_shocked.png

— "I only went to steal his files! He was already dead in the corridor!"

— Kevin Lin, Present E4 (Smartwatch Log) → Sprite switches to: kevin_panicked.png

— "I took a \$5,000 bribe to kill the cameras! I saw someone push a body on the

wheel!"

— Marcus Vance, Present E5 (Threatening Email) → Sprite switches to:

vance_angry.png

— "Knowing we had a dispute doesn't make me a killer, Detective."

Phase 4: The 60% Clue Verification Gate

When the player clicks "**Proceed to Final Indictment**", the engine evaluates the clue count:

$$\text{Evidence Check} = \frac{\text{Collected Clues}}{\text{Total Clues (6)}} \geq 60\% \quad (\geq 4 \text{ clues})$$

- **Less than 4 Clues:**
 - *System Message: "Insufficient Evidence! The prosecutor rejects your case. You need at least 4 confirmed clues to make an arrest. Return and investigate."*
- **4 or More Clues:**
 - *System Message: "Evidence threshold met. You have enough proof to secure a conviction. Step into the interrogation room."*

Phase 5: The Final Accusation (The Verdict)

- **Background:** bg_interrogation_room.png

Step 1: Name the Killer

- [A] Dr. Elena Cruz (*Incorrect - She only stole the USB drive*)
- [B] Kevin Lin (*Incorrect - He only disabled cameras for a bribe*)
- [C] **Marcus Vance** → **Correct!**

Step 2: Establish the Method

- [A] Dr. Thorne drank poison inside the locked cleanroom.
- [B] **Vance killed Thorne in the corridor, fed the body through the material conveyor**

during the 90-second camera blind spot, and ran the 65°C heat purge to destroy touch DNA. $\rightarrow$ **Correct!**

- [C] The killer sneaked through the air filtration duct.

Case Resolution:

- **Sprite:** vance_defeated.png
- **Dialogue (Marcus Vance):** *"He was going to destroy this company over minor calibration margins! I built this empire... and you think a junior detective can tear it down?"*
- **Victory Screen:** *"Case Solved! Grade: Master Detective. Chain of custody verified."*